

Testing Shit

Course Code: MTH201

Lecturer: Prof. Isaac Newton

sociology, a [social science](#) that studies human societies, their interactions, and the processes that preserve and change them. It does this by examining the [dynamics](#) of [constituent](#) parts of societies such as institutions, [communities](#), populations, and gender, racial, or age groups. Sociology also studies [social status](#) or stratification, [social movements](#), and [social change](#), as well as societal disorder in the form of crime, [deviance](#), and [revolution](#).

Social life overwhelmingly regulates the [behaviour of humans](#), largely because humans lack the instincts that guide most [animal behaviour](#). Humans therefore depend on [social institutions](#) and organizations to inform their decisions and actions. Given the important role organizations play in influencing human action, it is sociology's task to discover how organizations affect the behaviour of persons, how they are established, how organizations interact with one another, how they decay, and, ultimately, how they disappear. Among the most basic organizational structures are economic, religious, educational, and political institutions, as well as more specialized institutions such as the family, the [community](#), the military, peer groups, clubs, and volunteer associations.

Sociology, as a generalizing social science, is surpassed in its breadth only by [anthropology](#)—a [discipline](#) that [encompasses archaeology](#), [physical anthropology](#), and [linguistics](#). The broad nature of sociological inquiry causes it to overlap with other social sciences such as [economics](#), [political science](#), [psychology](#), [geography](#), [education](#), and [law](#). Sociology's distinguishing feature is its practice of drawing on a larger societal [context](#) to explain social phenomena.

Sociologists also utilize some aspects of these other fields. Psychology and sociology, for instance, share an interest in the subfield of [social psychology](#), although psychologists traditionally focus on individuals and their mental mechanisms. Sociology devotes most of its attention to the [collective](#) aspects of [human behaviour](#), because sociologists place greater emphasis on the ways external groups influence the behaviour of individuals.

The field of [social anthropology](#) has been historically quite close to sociology. Until about the first quarter of the 20th century, the two subjects were usually combined in one department (especially in Britain), [differentiated](#) mainly by anthropology's emphasis on

the sociology of preliterate peoples. Recently, however, this distinction has faded, as social anthropologists have turned their interests toward the study of modern [culture](#).

Two other social sciences, political science and economics, developed largely from the practical interests of nations. Increasingly, both fields have recognized the utility of sociological concepts and methods. A comparable [synergy](#) has also developed with respect to law, education, and religion and even in such contrasting fields as engineering and architecture. All of these fields can benefit from the study of institutions and social interaction.

Historical development of sociology

Though sociology draws on the Western tradition of rational inquiry established by the ancient Greeks, it is specifically the offspring of 18th- and 19th-century [philosophy](#) and has been viewed, along with economics and political science, as a reaction against speculative philosophy and folklore. Consequently, sociology separated from [moral philosophy](#) to become a specialized discipline. While he is not [credited](#) with the founding of the discipline of sociology, French philosopher [Auguste Comte](#) is recognized for having coined the term *sociology*.

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